



FULL-BLEED HERO PHOTOGRAPH
RECOMMENDED: NAPIER ART DECO / CAPE KIDNAPPERS

— YOUR JOURNEY BEGINS HERE

Hawke's Bay Relocation Guide

WRITTEN BY ETHICARE RESOURCING · TE MATAU-A-MĀUI



Kia ora, and a warm welcome to Aotearoa.

Kia ora, and a warm welcome to Hawke's Bay — Te Matau-a-Māui, New Zealand's celebrated food and wine country.

The twin cities of Napier and Hastings sit at the heart of a sunny, fertile region famous for its vineyards, orchards and the Art Deco architecture rebuilt after the 1931 earthquake. Life here is unhurried, with a strong sense of place and community.

This guide covers housing, transport, healthcare, finances and where to explore.



Lifestyle / welcome photograph

RECOMMENDED: NAPIER & HASTINGS WATERFRONT OR FAMILY

Nau mai, haere mai ki Aotearoa! (Welcome to New Zealand!)

Ngā mihi nui,
The Ethicare Team

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QUICK FACTS

LOCATION

Eastern North Island coast

CLIMATE

Warm, dry, sunny

DRIVE TO WELLINGTON

~4 hours

MAIN CITIES

Napier & Hastings (~140,000)

MAIN HOSPITAL

Hawke's Bay Hospital (Hastings)

NEARBY

Cape Kidnappers, wineries

New Zealand's wine country

Hawke's Bay wraps around a broad sweeping bay on the east coast, its warm dry climate making it one of New Zealand's premier wine and horticulture regions, anchored by the twin cities of Napier and Hastings.

140K

REGION RESIDENTS

90+

WINERIES ACROSS THE REGION

2,250_{HRS}

SUNSHINE A YEAR – AMONG NZ'S
HIGHEST

Why many professionals enjoy Hawke's Bay

- One of NZ's sunniest, driest climates
- A celebrated food, wine and farmers'-market scene
- Napier's world-famous Art Deco architecture
- An affordable, unhurried lifestyle

Art Deco and abundance

After a devastating 1931 earthquake, Napier was rebuilt almost entirely in the Art Deco style of the day — making it one of the world's finest collections of 1930s architecture.

The region celebrates this heritage every February with the Art Deco Festival, when vintage cars and 1930s dress fill the streets.

Hawke's Bay's identity is built on its land — vineyards, orchards and farmers' markets — and on strong Māori and settler histories along the coast.



Cultural moment

RECOMMENDED: NAPIER & HASTINGS LANDMARK

“

Napier wears its history beautifully — a whole city rebuilt in the optimism of the Art Deco age.

ON LIFE IN HAWKE'S BAY

Getting around

Here is how people get around Hawke's Bay day to day — and what to know about driving in New Zealand.

DRIVING

A car suits the region; State Highway 2 and 50 link the towns and wineries.

BUSES

The goBay network connects Napier, Hastings and surrounding towns.

AIR

Hawke's Bay Airport at Napier has frequent flights to Auckland, Wellington and Christchurch.

CYCLING

The Hawke's Bay Trails — flat, scenic cycleways — link the cities, coast and wineries.

On the road

- New Zealanders drive on the left
- You can usually drive on a valid overseas licence for up to 12 months before converting to a NZ one
- A local transport card makes buses and trains easy
- Keep your overseas licence and any translation handy when you first arrive

A year in the local climate

Hawke's Bay enjoys one of New Zealand's warmest, driest and sunniest climates — ideal for the grapes and fruit the region is known for. Summers are hot; winters mild and crisp.

Summer

DEC – FEB

23–28°

AVG DAYTIME

Autumn

MAR – MAY

18–23°

AVG DAYTIME

Winter

JUN – AUG

11–15°

AVG DAYTIME

Spring

SEP – NOV

16–21°

AVG DAYTIME



Seasonal / scenic photograph

RECOMMENDED: TE MATA PEAK / CAPE KIDNAPPERS

Hot dry summers are perfect for the beach and vineyards; winters bring clear, frosty mornings inland. Bring sun protection and a warm layer for evenings.

Healthcare in Hawke's Bay

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora delivers care across the region from Hawke's Bay Hospital in Hastings, the main centre serving both cities.

Hawke's Bay Hospital (Hastings)

The region's main public hospital – acute, surgical, medical, maternity and emergency services for Napier, Hastings and the wider bay.

Central Hawke's Bay Health Centre

Provides local healthcare for the southern part of the region at Waipukurau.

Tertiary referrals

Complex specialist cases are referred to Wellington Regional Hospital.

Private & ACC

Royston Hospital in Hastings is the region's private surgical hospital; ACC covers accidents for everyone.

Public & private

- Public healthcare is funded through general taxation
- ACC provides no-fault accident cover for everyone
- Private hospitals offer elective procedures and shorter waits
- Many residents hold private health insurance alongside the public system

GPs, pharmacies & urgent care

Registering with a GP and dentist

After you settle in, enrol with a local GP (General Practitioner). Enrolment means subsidised visits — typically around NZ\$50–\$70 when enrolled, more if you are a casual patient. Many practices allow online enrolment once you have an address. Dental care is private; expect roughly NZ\$90–\$150 for a check-up.

Pharmacies

Pharmacies are found throughout the region. Prescriptions are partly subsidised once you are enrolled with a GP — commonly a small standard charge per item.

Emergency & after-hours

- **Emergency Departments** — for urgent or critical care; in an emergency, dial 111
- **Urgent care clinics** — accident & medical clinics offer extended-hours care
- **Healthline 0800 611 116** — free 24/7 advice from registered nurses

Setting up your finances

Getting your finances in order early makes day-to-day life much easier. Most of this can be started before you arrive.

Opening a bank account

The major banks are ANZ, ASB, BNZ, Kiwibank and Westpac. You will usually need your passport, work or resident visa, and proof of a NZ address. Many banks let you start online before arrival, then activate in person. Ask for online banking and a debit card at the same time.

Tax (IRD number)

Every worker needs an IRD number from Inland Revenue. Apply online once you have a NZ address and bank account; processing usually takes around 7–10 working days. Give the number to your payroll team as soon as it arrives so the correct tax is applied. Wages are commonly paid fortnightly.

● Tip

Start your bank account application before you fly — having an account number ready makes your IRD application and payroll setup much smoother.

KiwiSaver & sending money home

KiwiSaver is a government-supported retirement savings scheme. On a work visa you can usually opt in or out. Contributions are a percentage of your pay (commonly 3%, 4%, 6%, 8% or 10%), with employers contributing at least 3%. You can withdraw your funds if you permanently leave New Zealand.

Sending money overseas: banks can transfer internationally, but specialist services such as Wise or OFX are often cheaper and faster. Always compare the exchange rate and the fees before moving larger amounts.

SET UP	WHY IT MATTERS	WHEN
Bank account	Receive salary, pay bills locally	Before / on arrival
IRD number	Be taxed correctly	First weeks
KiwiSaver	Retirement savings + employer top-up	When you start work
ACC	No-fault accident cover	Automatic

What life costs in Hawke's Bay

Hawke's Bay offers an appealing balance — housing more affordable than the big cities, paired with a sunny lifestyle and easy access to food and wine.

\$580/wk

3-BED HOUSE (APPROX. MEDIAN)

\$2.80/L

APPROX. PETROL PRICE

Left

SIDE OF THE ROAD

EVERYDAY ITEM	APPROX. PRICE (NZ\$)
1 litre of milk	\$2.50 – \$3.50
Loaf of bread	\$2.50 – \$4.00
Dozen eggs	\$7 – \$10
Flat white coffee	\$5.50 – \$6.50
Mid-range meal for one	\$25 – \$40
Monthly gym membership	\$60 – \$100
Home broadband	\$75 – \$100 / month

Prices are indicative and change over time — use the calculators at the back of this guide for a personalised estimate.

An example monthly budget

A rough single-person monthly budget for a Hawke's Bay renter. Yours will vary with lifestyle, household size and suburb.

CATEGORY	APPROX. MONTHLY (NZ\$)
Rent (room / small 1-bed)	\$1,300 – \$2,000
Power & water	\$150 – \$230
Internet	\$75 – \$100
Transport / fuel	\$170 – \$290
Groceries	\$450 – \$650
Mobile phone	\$30 – \$50
Entertainment	\$180 – \$350
Estimated total	\$2,400 – \$3,700

Make it personal

- Use Numbeo to compare Hawke's Bay with your current city
- Map your own incomings and outgoings with the Sorted budget planner (sorted.org.nz)

A note from Sophie

A personal word from our Founder on what makes Hawke's Bay special — and who it tends to suit.



● SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

Hawke's Bay is for people who want the good life without the rush — sunshine, world-class food and wine, and a community that genuinely makes time for you.

Napier and Hastings give you city services with a small-town warmth. It's one of the loveliest places we place people, and the lifestyle sells itself.

Sophie Careem · Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing

● From the Ethicare team

Your Ethicare contact is here to help with every step of your move to Hawke's Bay — from accommodation to payroll setup. Reach out any time.

Finding a place to live

From Napier's seaside suburbs to Hastings' leafy streets and rural lifestyle blocks, Hawke's Bay offers space and character at reasonable prices.



Housing / suburb photograph

RECOMMENDED: SUBURBAN STREET OR APARTMENTS

Useful property websites

- trademe.co.nz/property – NZ's largest rental marketplace
- realestate.co.nz – nationwide rentals and homes for sale

A guide to the areas

An orientation to the main areas of Hawke's Bay – each with its own character, price point and who it tends to suit.

Napier city & Mairewa

Walkable Art Deco streets and seaside suburbs near the waterfront.

Hastings & Havelock North

Hastings is the commercial hub; Havelock North is a sought-after village beneath Te Mata Peak.

Ahuriri

Napier's revitalised harbour-side precinct with dining, apartments and marina living.

Taradale

A popular suburb between the cities, with schools and the EIT campus nearby.

Across the wider region

Havelock North

A sought-after village beneath Te Mata Peak, with good schools and cafés.

Napier suburbs

Seaside Ahuriri, Marewa's Art Deco streets and the hill suburbs.

Hastings & Flaxmere

The commercial hub and more affordable family suburbs.

Central Hawke's Bay

Rural towns like Waipukurau and Waipawa for country living.

A tip on choosing

- Think about your commute to work and school zones if you have children
- Where you live can decide which state school your children attend – check the zone before you sign
- Many people rent for a few months first to get to know the areas

Utilities, rates & rubbish

POWER & GAS

Choose from providers like Genesis, Mercury, Meridian and Contact. Compare rates on Powerswitch (powerswitch.org.nz).

WATER & RATES

Council rates fund local services; if you rent, rates are usually included in your rent.

RUBBISH & RECYCLING

Kerbside collection is run by the local council, with separate bins for rubbish, recycling and food scraps.

INTERNET

Most homes have fibre broadband; Spark, One NZ and 2degrees are the main providers.

Set-up quick links

Compare power

powerswitch.org.nz

Post & parcels

nzpost.co.nz

Tenancy advice

tenancy.govt.nz

Where to shop

Hawke's Bay offers malls, town centres and weekend markets. A few of the main ones:

Napier & Hastings CBDs

Two walkable city centres with boutiques and department stores.

Ahuriri (Napier)

The revitalised harbour precinct for dining and shopping.

Havelock North village

Boutique shopping and the Black Barn and farmers' markets.

Markets

The famous Hawke's Bay Farmers' Market and Napier's Urban Market.

Supermarkets & groceries

New Zealand's supermarkets fall into a few main groups. Knowing the difference helps you balance budget and convenience.

Pak'nSave

The cheapest of the big chains — a no-frills, bulk-buy warehouse format. Best for budget shopping.

Woolworths

Mid-range and widespread, with strong online shopping and delivery (formerly Countdown).

New World

More upmarket, with a wider fresh and specialty range.

Four Square & FreshChoice

Smaller neighbourhood stores for convenience and top-ups.

Napier and Hastings both have Pak'nSave, Woolworths and New World; rural towns have New World and Four Square. Bring your own bags — single-use plastic bags are banned.

Specialty & international food

One of the joys of settling into Hawke's Bay is finding the flavours of home — or exploring new ones.

Halal & South Asian

A growing selection in Hastings and Napier; many supermarket meat lines are halal-certified.

Asian groceries

Asian supermarkets and restaurants serve both cities.

World food & wine

The region's real strength is its food and wine — orchards, cellar doors and markets.

Smaller independent stores open and close over time — a quick search for "halal butcher near me" or your home cuisine will surface the current options near your suburb.

Places of worship

Hawke's Bay reflects New Zealand's spiritual diversity, with welcoming communities across many faiths.

Napier and Hastings have Christian churches of many denominations, a mosque, and Hindu and other faith communities.

Finding your community

- Most faith communities list service times and locations online
- Many warmly welcome newcomers and visitors
- They can be one of the quickest ways to build a support network when you arrive

Sun, vines and the sea

Hawke's Bay rewards the outdoors and the table alike — cycle between cellar doors, climb Te Mata Peak, or watch the gannets at Cape Kidnappers.



Recreation hero photograph

RECOMMENDED: TE MATA PEAK / CAPE KIDNAPPERS

Don't-miss experiences

- Cycle the wine trails between cellar doors
- Climb Te Mata Peak for sweeping views
- See the gannet colony at Cape Kidnappers
- Wander Napier's Art Deco quarter

Ten things not to miss

A starter list to get to know Hawke's Bay and the wider region.

- 1 Te Mata Peak**
Climb or drive for sweeping views over the bay.
- 2 Cape Kidnappers**
See the world's largest mainland gannet colony.
- 3 Napier Art Deco quarter**
Wander one of the world's finest 1930s streetscapes.
- 4 Wine trails**
Cycle between cellar doors in the wine country.
- 5 Marine Parade**
Napier's elegant seafront and the National Aquarium.
- 6 Farmers' Market**
The celebrated Sunday market at the Showgrounds.
- 7 Ocean Beach**
A wild, beautiful surf beach near Havelock North.
- 8 Tūtira & the ranges**
Walks and lakes in the hinterland.
- 9 Art Deco Festival**
February's vintage celebration (seasonal).
- 10 Birdwoods & Arataki**
Gardens, sweet shops and honey near Havelock North.

Travel from Napier

Hawke's Bay is a great base for exploring. Some favourite weekend escapes:

Wellington (~4 hrs)

The capital for events and city life.

Taupō (~2.5 hrs)

The great lake and geothermal country.

Gisborne (~3 hrs)

First to see the sun, with surf and wine.

Central Hawke's Bay (~1 hr)

Quiet country towns and beaches.

Flying onward

- Domestic flights reach the main centres in around 1–2 hours
- Book early for the best fares on Air New Zealand and Jetstar
- Many regions are also linked by scenic road and rail journeys

Schooling & study

Hawke's Bay offers a full range of early childhood education, schools and tertiary study.

Early Childhood Education (ECE)

Kindergartens, daycare, Montessori, kōhanga reo and home-based care for ages 0–5. Government 20-hours funding applies for ages 3–5.

Primary & intermediate

State, state-integrated and private schools for Years 1–8.

Secondary

Years 9–13, working towards NCEA, the national qualification.

Tertiary

Universities and institutes of technology across the country.

School terms run late January to mid-December, in four terms with two-week breaks in April, July and October.

School zones come first

In New Zealand, where you live usually determines which state school your children can attend. For many families, the school decision leads the choice of where to rent or buy.

In-zone = guaranteed

Children living inside a school's enrolment zone are guaranteed a place at that school.

Out-of-zone = ballot

If you live outside the zone you can still apply, but places aren't guaranteed – popular schools run a ballot for limited spots.

Zones are street-by-street

Boundaries can run down the middle of a street, so check the exact address.

● **The order that works best**

1) Shortlist schools you like → 2) Check each school's zone map → 3) Search for rentals inside that zone → 4) Confirm the address is in-zone before you sign.

Childcare for working families

Early childhood (0–5). Daycare, kindergartens, Montessori and home-based care are widely available. The government's 20 Hours ECE funding subsidises care for ages 3–5 at participating centres.

Before & after school (OSCAR). Many schools and providers run breakfast clubs, after-school care and holiday programmes. Subsidies may be available through Work and Income for eligible families.

TYPE OF CARE	APPROX. COST (NZ\$)
Full-time daycare (under 3)	\$350 – \$450 / week before subsidies
20 Hours ECE (ages 3–5)	Up to 20 hrs/week subsidised; extra hours charged
After-school care (OSCAR)	\$5 – \$15 per afternoon, varies by provider
School holiday programme	\$40 – \$60 per day, activity-based

Costs are indicative and vary by provider and suburb. If you'll work shifts, ask providers about flexible hours.

Hawke's Bay for families

Beyond school and work, Hawke's Bay is an easy, outdoorsy place to raise a family.

FREE & OUTDOORS

Marine Parade, beaches and Te Mata Park – much of the fun is free.

RAINY-DAY OPTIONS

The National Aquarium, MTG Hawke's Bay museum and Splash Planet.

LIBRARIES & PLUNKET

Free libraries run children's programmes; Plunket supports young families.

GETTING AROUND

Flat, sunny and cycle-friendly – easy for families to get around.

Settling kids in

- Children often settle fastest through school, sport and weekend activities
- Local clubs – football, netball, rugby, swimming – are inexpensive and welcoming
- They're a great way for the whole family to meet people

Pre-departure checklist

Work through these before you fly. Keep digital and printed copies of everything important.

Documents

- ☐ Passport + valid NZ visa (printed too)
- ☐ Job offer & employment contract
- ☐ Qualifications & certificates
- ☐ References & employment history

Money & travel

- ☐ Apply online for a NZ bank account
- ☐ Documents ready for your IRD number
- ☐ Confirm airline baggage allowance
- ☐ Book temporary accommodation

Your first weeks

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Move into your accommodation | ☐ Open / activate your bank account |
| ☐ Apply for your IRD number | ☐ Get a NZ SIM card |
| ☐ Register with a local GP | ☐ Set up power, water and internet |
| ☐ Learn your transport routes to work | ☐ Save 111 and Healthline in your phone |
| ☐ Find your nearest pharmacy & supermarket | ☐ Explore your local neighbourhood |

● You're not alone

Your Ethicare contact is here to help with any of these steps – from accommodation to payroll setup. Reach out any time.

Key numbers & contacts

In any emergency – police, fire or ambulance – dial **111**.

Emergency & health

Emergency	111
Healthline	0800 611 116
Mental health	Call/text 1737
Police (non-urgent)	105

Everyday services

Tax (IRD)	ird.govt.nz
Immigration	immigration.govt.nz
AA roadside	0800 500 222
Local council	govt.nz/organisations

Banks

ANZ	anz.co.nz
ASB	asb.co.nz
BNZ	bnz.co.nz
Kiwibank	kiwibank.co.nz
Westpac	westpac.co.nz

Community & expat groups

One of the quickest ways to settle in is to find your people. Hawke's Bay has active communities for almost every interest and background.

Facebook groups

Search for groups like "Expats in Hawke's Bay", your home-country community, and local suburb buy/sell and parents' groups.

Meetup & interest groups

Meetup.com lists hiking, sport, hobby and newcomer groups — a relaxed way to meet people.

Sports & cultural clubs

Local football, netball, rugby and cricket clubs, plus cultural and faith communities, all welcome newcomers.

Workplace networks

Many hospitals and employers have social clubs and buddy systems for new and international staff.

Rainbow / LGBTQ+ community

- New Zealand is welcoming and progressive — marriage equality has been law since 2013
- There are strong legal protections against discrimination
- OutLine Aotearoa offers rainbow mental-health support (0800 688 5463)

Everyday Māori & Kiwi phrases

Te reo Māori is part of everyday life, and Kiwis have their own slang too.

Te reo Māori

Kia ora Hello / thanks

Nau mai, haere mai Welcome

Whānau Family

Hauora Health & wellbeing

Manaakitanga Hospitality, kindness

Mōrena Good morning

Ka kite anō See you later

Tamariki Children

Ngā mihi nui Many thanks

Aotearoa New Zealand

Kiwi slang

Sweet as Great / no worries

Keen Up for it

Dairy Corner shop

Jandals Flip-flops

Flatting Shared renting

Chur Cheers / thanks

Heaps Lots

Togs Swimwear

Shout Your turn to pay

Knackered Tired

Work out your cost of living.

Use these tools to estimate what life in Hawke's Bay would really cost for you and your family.

Cost-of-living calculators

Compare cities (Numbeo)	numbeo.com/cost-of-living
Budget planner (Sorted)	sorted.org.nz/tools/budget-planner
Living-costs data (Stats NZ)	stats.govt.nz
Take-home pay (IRD)	ird.govt.nz

We hope you've found this guide useful. Moving to the other side of the world is a big step, and there's a lot to take in – so please don't feel you have to have it all figured out at once.

Whatever stage you're at, we're always happy to talk anything through – the big decisions or the small worries. Just reach out to your Ethicare contact whenever you need us.

Ngā mihi nui

The Ethicare team



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